



AZM.AIO (Pvt.) Ltd.

AZM SCHOLARSHIP POLICY MANUAL - Version 1.0

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CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

1.1 Purpose of the Manual

This Scholarship Policy Manual establishes the official policies, procedures, standards, and governance framework for the administration of the **AZM Scholarship Program** by **AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd**. It serves as the primary reference document for the Board of Directors, Director General & Chairperson, Scholarship Committee, employees, partner institutions, scholarship applicants, parents/guardians, and scholarship recipients.

The purpose of this Manual is to ensure that every stage of the scholarship process is conducted in a fair, transparent, accountable, merit-based, and professionally managed manner while maintaining the highest standards of integrity, equal opportunity, and institutional governance.

1.2 About AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd

AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd is an educational and welfare organization committed to promoting academic excellence through innovative educational initiatives, scholarships, student development programs, and community welfare projects.

The organization operates with the objective of creating opportunities for talented, deserving, orphan, and financially disadvantaged students by reducing financial barriers to education and encouraging academic achievement.

AZM believes that education is one of the most effective tools for social development and national progress. Through its scholarship initiatives, the organization seeks to recognize merit, support deserving students, and contribute to the development of responsible future leaders.

1.3 About the AZM Scholarship Program

The **AZM Scholarship Program** is the flagship educational initiative of **AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd**, designed to identify and support students with strong academic potential through a structured and transparent selection process.

Scholarships are awarded after evaluating applicants on the basis of merit, interviews, document verification, eligibility criteria, and other assessment procedures approved by AZM.

The program may provide financial assistance, tuition fee support, educational resources, academic awards, and other approved educational benefits, subject to company policies and available resources.

1.4 Scope

This Manual applies to:

- The Board of Directors.
- Director General & Chairperson.
- Executive Management.
- AZM Scholarship Committee.
- Employees and Volunteers involved in scholarship administration.
- Partner Schools, Colleges, and Educational Institutions.
- Scholarship Applicants.
- Parents and Guardians.
- Scholarship Recipients.

Compliance with this Manual is mandatory for all persons participating in or administering the AZM Scholarship Program.

1.5 Objectives

The objectives of the AZM Scholarship Program are to:

- Promote merit-based educational opportunities.
- Support talented and deserving students.
- Assist orphan and financially disadvantaged students.
- Encourage academic excellence and leadership.
- Promote transparency, accountability, and fairness in scholarship administration.
- Strengthen partnerships with educational institutions.
- Contribute towards educational and social development.

1.6 Guiding Principles

The administration of the AZM Scholarship Program shall be based on the following principles:

- Merit
- Transparency
- Fairness
- Equal Opportunity
- Accountability
- Integrity
- Professionalism
- Confidentiality
- Non-Discrimination
- Continuous Improvement

1.7 Legal Status

The AZM Scholarship Program is a voluntary educational assistance initiative administered by **AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd** in accordance with its approved policies and governance framework.

The scholarship is granted at the discretion of AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd and is subject to eligibility criteria, merit evaluation, document verification, available resources, and compliance with this Manual. Participation in the Scholarship Program does not create any employment, partnership, ownership, or contractual right beyond the scholarship benefits expressly approved by the organization.

1.8 Applicability

By submitting an application or accepting any scholarship benefit, every applicant, parent/guardian, and scholarship recipient acknowledges that they have read, understood, and agreed to comply with this Scholarship Policy Manual, including any amendments approved by AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd from time to time.

1.9 Effective Date

This Scholarship Policy Manual shall become effective from the date of its approval by the **Board of Directors of AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd** and shall remain in force until amended, revised, or replaced by the Board.

Document Control

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Custodian: Director General & Chairperson

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CHAPTER 2

VISION, MISSION, CORE VALUES & OBJECTIVES

2.1 Vision

To become Pakistan's most trusted, transparent, and impactful scholarship organization by empowering talented, deserving, orphan, and financially disadvantaged students through quality educational opportunities and sustainable academic support.

2.2 Mission

AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd is committed to promoting educational excellence by identifying deserving students through a transparent, merit-based, and professionally managed scholarship system.

The organization strives to remove financial barriers, encourage academic achievement, develop future leaders, and strengthen educational institutions through strategic partnerships and responsible governance.

2.3 Core Values

The AZM Scholarship Program shall operate in accordance with the following core values:

Merit

Scholarships shall be awarded strictly on approved merit and eligibility criteria without favoritism or discrimination.

Transparency

All scholarship processes shall be conducted openly, honestly, and in accordance with approved policies.

Integrity

Every decision shall be made honestly, ethically, and in the best interest of the Scholarship Program.

Fairness

Every applicant shall be given equal opportunity to compete under the same evaluation standards.

Accountability

AZM officials, committee members, applicants, and scholarship recipients shall remain accountable for their responsibilities and actions.

Professionalism

All scholarship activities shall be conducted with dignity, respect, discipline, and administrative excellence.

Confidentiality

Personal information and scholarship records shall be protected and handled responsibly.

Continuous Improvement

AZM shall regularly review and improve its scholarship policies, procedures, and operational practices.

2.4 Strategic Objectives

The AZM Scholarship Program aims to:

1. Promote equal access to quality education.
2. Encourage academic excellence and healthy competition.
3. Support talented students who demonstrate outstanding academic potential.
4. Provide educational assistance to orphan and financially deserving students.
5. Develop future leaders with strong ethical values and social responsibility.
6. Strengthen collaboration with partner schools, colleges, and educational institutions.
7. Promote transparency, accountability, and institutional credibility in scholarship administration.
8. Encourage innovation, leadership, volunteerism, and community service among scholarship recipients.

9. Ensure efficient utilization of scholarship funds and educational resources.
10. Build a sustainable scholarship system capable of serving future generations.

2.5 Commitment to Merit and Fairness

AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd is committed to maintaining a scholarship system based on fairness, impartiality, and objective evaluation.

Scholarship decisions shall be made after consideration of applicable eligibility requirements, examination performance, interview assessment, document verification, and other approved evaluation criteria.

No applicant shall receive preferential treatment on the basis of personal relationships, recommendations, political influence, financial influence, race, religion, ethnicity, gender, or any other irrelevant factor.

2.6 Commitment to Educational Excellence

The organization recognizes education as a fundamental driver of personal development and national progress.

Through the AZM Scholarship Program, the organization seeks to:

- Encourage continuous learning.
- Recognize academic achievement.
- Reward discipline and commitment.
- Promote responsible citizenship.
- Inspire students to become future professionals and community leaders.

2.7 Institutional Commitment

AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd is committed to:

- Maintaining the highest standards of governance.
- Ensuring transparent scholarship administration.
- Respecting the dignity of every applicant.
- Protecting confidential information.
- Continuously improving scholarship policies and procedures.
- Working collaboratively with partner educational institutions.
- Delivering educational assistance responsibly and sustainably.

2.8 Equal Opportunity Policy

The AZM Scholarship Program is committed to providing equal opportunity to all eligible applicants.

Selection shall be based solely on approved scholarship criteria and evaluation procedures. No applicant shall be discriminated against on grounds unrelated to the scholarship requirements.

2.9 Policy Review

The Vision, Mission, Core Values, and Objectives contained in this Manual shall be reviewed periodically by the Board of Directors to ensure they remain aligned with the strategic goals of AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd and the evolving needs of the Scholarship Program.

Chapter Summary

The Vision, Mission, Core Values, and Strategic Objectives set the guiding direction for every policy, decision, and activity undertaken under the AZM Scholarship Program. All stakeholders are expected to uphold these principles while participating in or administering the Scholarship Program.

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CHAPTER 3

GOVERNANCE STRUCTURE, AUTHORITY & RESPONSIBILITIES

3.1 Purpose

This chapter establishes the governance framework for the AZM Scholarship Program and defines the authority, responsibilities, and accountability of all individuals and bodies involved in its administration.

The governance structure is designed to ensure that all scholarship-related decisions are made fairly, transparently, professionally, and in accordance with this Policy Manual.

3.2 Governance Structure

The AZM Scholarship Program shall operate under the following governance hierarchy:

Board of Directors



Director General & Chairperson



Executive Director



Scholarship Committee



Verification & Compliance Team



Finance Department



Administrative Staff & Volunteers

All stakeholders shall perform their duties within the limits of the authority assigned under this Manual.

3.3 Board of Directors

The Board of Directors shall be the supreme governing authority responsible for strategic oversight of the Scholarship Program.

Responsibilities

The Board shall:

- Approve scholarship policies and amendments.
- Approve the annual scholarship budget.
- Approve scholarship categories and strategic objectives.
- Appoint or remove members of the Scholarship Committee where applicable.
- Review annual performance reports.
- Ensure good governance, accountability, and compliance.

The Board shall not participate in the assessment of individual scholarship applications except where required by law or company policy.

3.4 Director General & Chairperson

The Director General & Chairperson shall be the Chief Executive Authority of the Scholarship Program and shall exercise overall supervision and control over its administration.

Powers

The Director General & Chairperson may:

- Approve the final merit list.
- Approve scholarship awards.
- Approve policy amendments.
- Suspend or cancel scholarships in accordance with this Manual.
- Approve exceptional cases where justified.
- Issue official circulars, notifications, and directives.
- Interpret this Policy Manual where clarification is required.
- Delegate administrative functions to authorized officers.

The Director General & Chairperson shall ensure that all scholarship decisions are made fairly, consistently, and in accordance with approved policies.

3.5 Executive Director

The Executive Director shall oversee the day-to-day administration of the Scholarship Program.

Responsibilities

The Executive Director shall:

- Implement Board policies.

- Coordinate scholarship operations.
- Supervise staff and volunteers.
- Ensure timely completion of scholarship activities.
- Monitor compliance with this Manual.
- Present reports to the Director General.
- Coordinate with partner institutions.

3.6 Scholarship Committee

The Scholarship Committee shall be the principal evaluation body responsible for reviewing scholarship applications and making recommendations.

Responsibilities

The Committee shall:

- Review applications.
- Verify eligibility.
- Evaluate written test results.
- Conduct or supervise interviews.
- Prepare provisional merit lists.
- Review verification reports.
- Recommend scholarship awards.
- Maintain confidentiality and impartiality.

The Committee shall record the reasons for significant decisions and maintain appropriate documentation.

3.7 Verification & Compliance Team

The Verification Team shall independently verify the authenticity of information submitted by applicants.

Responsibilities

The Team may:

- Verify academic records.
- Verify institutional enrollment.
- Verify financial information.
- Conduct home visits where approved.
- Verify identity documents.
- Investigate discrepancies.
- Submit verification reports.

Verification findings shall be documented and retained in accordance with the records management policy.

3.8 Finance Department

The Finance Department shall be responsible for the financial administration of the Scholarship Program.

Responsibilities

The Department shall:

- Maintain financial records.
- Process approved scholarship payments.
- Maintain scholarship expenditure records.
- Prepare financial reports.
- Assist with financial audits.
- Ensure compliance with approved budgets.

3.9 Administrative Staff & Volunteers

Administrative staff and volunteers shall support scholarship operations within the authority assigned to them.

They shall:

- Maintain confidentiality.
- Protect applicant information.
- Follow official procedures.
- Avoid conflicts of interest.
- Perform duties professionally and ethically.

3.10 Partner Educational Institutions

Partner institutions play an important role in facilitating the Scholarship Program.

They may:

- Disseminate scholarship information.
- Facilitate student registration.
- Verify institutional records.
- Provide academic information when requested.
- Assist in student monitoring.

Partner institutions shall not influence scholarship decisions or guarantee scholarship awards.

3.11 Delegation of Authority

The Director General & Chairperson may delegate administrative responsibilities to authorized officers where necessary.

Delegation of responsibility shall not relieve the Director General & Chairperson of overall accountability for the proper administration of the Scholarship Program.

3.12 Conflict of Interest

All individuals involved in the scholarship process shall disclose any actual, potential, or perceived conflict of interest.

A person with a conflict of interest shall not participate in the evaluation or decision-making process concerning the affected applicant.

Failure to disclose a conflict of interest may result in disciplinary action.

3.13 Confidentiality

All scholarship records, applicant information, interview assessments, financial information, and committee deliberations shall be treated as confidential.

Such information shall only be accessed by authorized personnel for official purposes.

Unauthorized disclosure may result in disciplinary action.

3.14 Accountability

Every officer, committee member, employee, volunteer, and partner institution involved in the Scholarship Program shall be accountable for complying with this Policy Manual.

Any breach of these policies may result in disciplinary or administrative action.

3.15 Final Authority

Subject to applicable law and the governing documents of AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd:

- The **Board of Directors** shall exercise strategic oversight.
- The **Director General & Chairperson** shall be the final approving authority for scholarship decisions.
- The **Scholarship Committee** shall recommend decisions based on merit, eligibility, and verification.

No officer, employee, volunteer, partner institution, or external individual is authorized to alter scholarship decisions except in accordance with this Policy Manual.

Chapter Summary

This governance framework ensures clear roles, defined authority, accountability, transparency, and proper oversight in the administration of the AZM Scholarship Program.

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Chapter: 3 – Governance Structure, Authority & Responsibilities

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CHAPTER 4

SCHOLARSHIP CATEGORIES & BENEFITS

4.1 Self-Funded Scholarship Policy

The **AZM Scholarship Program** is an independent educational welfare initiative that is **entirely self-funded by AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd** through its own approved financial resources.

Scholarship awards, educational benefits, and the number of scholarships offered in any academic session shall depend upon:

- The annual scholarship budget approved by the Board of Directors.
- The financial capacity of AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd.
- Operational requirements.
- Strategic priorities of the organization.

Accordingly:

- Scholarship categories, benefits, and available seats may be increased, reduced, suspended, restructured, or discontinued at any time.
- No scholarship shall be regarded as a permanent entitlement or guaranteed benefit.
- Publication of scholarship categories or seat allocations for one session shall not create any obligation to offer identical categories or numbers in future sessions.
- All scholarship awards remain subject to the financial sustainability of the AZM Scholarship Program.

4.2 Scholarship Categories

The AZM Scholarship Program consists of the following categories:

Category A – Full-Year Scholarship

Category B – Semester Fee Waiver Scholarship

Category C – Educational Benefits Scholarship

Category D – Orphan & Financially Needy Scholarship

Each category shall have separate eligibility criteria and benefits as determined by AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd.

4.3 Category A – Full-Year Scholarship

The Full-Year Scholarship is the highest category of scholarship awarded by AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd.

Benefits

Eligible students may receive:

- Up to **100% tuition fee support according to AZM policies** for one academic year.
- Scholarship Certificate.
- Academic recognition.
- Priority consideration for educational opportunities offered by AZM.
- Other approved educational benefits, subject to company policy.

Special Awards

The **Top Two Overall Merit Position Holders** may be awarded either:

- **One Sided Umrah Ticket valid upto 3 months, or**
- **A Full-Year Scholarship**

The nature of the award shall be determined and announced by AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd.

Eligibility

Selection shall be based on:

- Merit ranking.
- Interview performance.
- Verification of documents.
- Compliance with scholarship policies.

4.4 Category B – Semester Fee Waiver Scholarship

Semester Scholarships are awarded to students who demonstrate strong academic merit but do not qualify for the Full-Year Scholarship.

Scholarships may include:

- **60% Tuition Fee Waiver**
- **50% Tuition Fee Waiver**
- **40% Tuition Fee Waiver**
- **30% Tuition Fee Waiver**
- **20% Tuition Fee Waiver**

The applicable percentage shall be determined solely by the Scholarship Committee based on merit ranking and available resources.

Benefits apply only for the approved academic semester unless renewed in accordance with company policy.

4.5 Category C – Educational Benefits Scholarship

Students who do not receive tuition fee support may still be considered for educational assistance.

Educational benefits may include:

- Laptop
- Chromebook
- Textbooks
- Stationery
- Examination Support
- Learning Resources
- Educational Kits

- Other educational assistance approved by AZM.

The type, quantity, and value of educational benefits shall be determined solely by AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd.

4.6 Category D – Orphan & Financially Needy Scholarship

A dedicated category is reserved for orphan and financially deserving students.

Selection shall be based upon:

- Financial assessment.
- Verification of supporting documents.
- Interview.
- Home verification (where required).
- Overall need assessment.

Scholarship assistance may include:

- Tuition Fee Support.
- Educational Benefits.
- Learning Materials.
- Other welfare assistance approved by AZM.

4.7 Number of Scholarships

The number of scholarships awarded in each category shall be determined annually by AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd.

For the current scholarship session:

- **20 Full-Year Scholarships**
- **40 Semester Fee Waiver Scholarships**
- **60 Educational Benefits Scholarships**
- **30 Orphan & Financially Needy Scholarships**

The organization reserves the right to increase, reduce, reallocate, or withdraw scholarships based on available resources, policy decisions, or operational requirements.

4.8 Scholarship Duration

Unless otherwise approved:

- Full-Year Scholarships remain valid for one academic year.
- Semester Scholarships remain valid for one academic semester.
- Educational Benefits are provided as approved by AZM.
- Orphan & Financially Needy Scholarships shall remain valid for the approved period.

Continuation beyond the approved period shall not be automatic.

4.9 Scholarship Renewal

Renewal of any scholarship shall be subject to:

- Maintaining at least **70% marks** in internal examinations.
- Minimum **90% attendance**.
- Good conduct and discipline.
- Compliance with scholarship policies.
- Continued eligibility.
- Availability of scholarship funds.

Renewal shall be considered independently and shall not be guaranteed.

4.10 Limitations

Unless expressly approved by AZM:

- A student may not receive more than one scholarship category simultaneously.
- Scholarship benefits are **non-transferable, non-convertible, and non-exchangeable**.
- Scholarship benefits shall not be redeemed for cash.
- Scholarships may not be assigned or transferred to another individual.

4.11 Modification of Benefits

AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd reserves the right to:

- Modify scholarship categories.
- Increase or decrease scholarship benefits.
- Introduce new scholarship categories.
- Discontinue any scholarship category.
- Change eligibility requirements.

Such changes shall apply from the effective date notified by AZM.

4.12 Final Authority

The classification of a student under any scholarship category shall be determined solely by the **Scholarship Committee**, subject to the approval of the **Director General & Chairperson**.

No applicant shall have the right to demand placement in a higher scholarship category or claim benefits beyond those officially approved.

Chapter Summary

The AZM Scholarship Program offers multiple categories of educational assistance to recognize merit and support deserving students. Every scholarship category is governed by approved eligibility criteria, available resources, and the policies of AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd. Scholarship awards remain discretionary and subject to compliance with this Manual.

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CHAPTER 5

ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA & DISQUALIFICATION POLICY

5.1 Purpose

This chapter establishes the eligibility requirements, document standards, verification procedures, and grounds for disqualification applicable to all applicants under the AZM Scholarship Program.

5.2 General Eligibility

An applicant shall be eligible to apply for the AZM Scholarship Program if he/she:

1. Is enrolled in a recognized school or college approved by the relevant education authority.
2. Falls within the classes or academic levels announced for the relevant scholarship session.
3. Completes the official scholarship application within the prescribed deadline.
4. Submits all required documents.
5. Appears in the written examination and interview (where applicable).
6. Accepts all terms, conditions, and policies of AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd.

Meeting the eligibility criteria does **not** guarantee selection or the award of a scholarship.

5.3 Required Documents

Applicants shall submit the following documents, where applicable:

- Completed Scholarship Application Form.
- Student B-Form or CNIC.
- Parent/Guardian CNIC.
- Recent Passport-Size Photographs.
- Latest Academic Result Card/Transcript.
- Bonafide Certificate or Enrollment Certificate.
- Income Certificate or Proof of Financial Need (where required).
- Orphan Certificate or Death Certificate (for Orphan Category).
- Disability Certificate (if applicable).
- Any additional document requested by AZM.

AZM reserves the right to request additional documents at any stage of the scholarship process.

5.4 Verification of Information

All documents and information submitted by applicants may be verified through:

- Educational institutions.

- Government authorities.
- Parents/Guardians.
- Home verification (where necessary).
- Interviews.
- Other lawful means deemed appropriate by AZM.

Providing information to AZM constitutes consent for such verification.

5.5 Merit-Based Selection

Eligible applicants shall be assessed through:

- Written Examination.
- Interview.
- Academic Performance.
- Document Verification.
- Financial Assessment (where applicable).
- Any additional evaluation criteria approved by AZM.

Scholarships shall be awarded strictly according to merit and approved selection procedures.

5.6 Grounds for Disqualification

An applicant may be disqualified at any stage if he/she:

- Submits false, forged, altered, or misleading documents.
- Conceals material information.
- Provides incorrect personal or academic details.
- Uses unfair means during the examination or interview.
- Attempts to influence the selection process through improper means.
- Fails to submit required documents within the prescribed time.
- Refuses to cooperate during verification.
- Violates any provision of this Policy Manual.

Disqualification may occur before or after the publication of the merit list if a violation is discovered.

5.7 Rejection of Application

AZM may reject any application without further processing if:

- The application is incomplete.
- Required documents are missing.
- The application is submitted after the deadline.
- Eligibility requirements are not met.
- The information provided cannot be verified.
- The applicant fails to appear for the examination or interview without an acceptable reason.

5.8 Misrepresentation and Fraud

Any applicant found guilty of fraud, forgery, impersonation, document tampering, or deliberate misrepresentation shall:

- Be disqualified from the current scholarship session.
- Have any awarded scholarship cancelled.
- Be barred from future AZM scholarship programs, where appropriate.
- Be subject to any further action permitted under applicable law.

5.9 No Right to Selection

Submission of an application, appearance in the examination or interview, or meeting the minimum eligibility criteria shall **not** create any legal or contractual right to receive a scholarship.

Selection depends upon:

- Merit ranking.
- Eligibility.
- Verification.
- Available scholarships.
- Approval by the Director General & Chairperson upon the recommendation of the Scholarship Committee.

5.10 Reservation of Rights

AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd reserves the right to:

- Verify any document at any stage.
- Request additional information.
- Reassess an applicant's eligibility.
- Disqualify any applicant found in violation of this Manual.
- Amend eligibility criteria for future scholarship sessions.

5.11 Final Authority

The determination of an applicant's eligibility or disqualification shall be made by the **Scholarship Committee**, subject to the approval of the **Director General & Chairperson**.

The decision shall constitute the final administrative determination of AZM regarding eligibility.

Chapter Summary

The AZM Scholarship Program is founded on merit, transparency, and integrity. Every applicant must satisfy the prescribed eligibility criteria and successfully complete the verification process. Any attempt to misrepresent information, manipulate the process, or violate scholarship policies may result in rejection or disqualification.

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CHAPTER 6

SCHOLARSHIP APPLICATION, REGISTRATION & SELECTION PROCESS

6.1 Purpose

This chapter establishes the official procedure for the application, registration, evaluation, selection, and award of scholarships under the AZM Scholarship Program. The objective is to ensure that every applicant is assessed through a transparent, fair, and standardized process.

6.2 Scholarship Announcement

AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd shall announce each scholarship session through its official communication channels. The announcement may include:

- Scholarship categories
- Eligibility criteria
- Number of scholarships
- Registration schedule
- Examination and interview dates
- Required documents
- Important instructions

Only information published through official AZM channels shall be considered authentic.

6.3 Application & Registration

Applicants shall:

1. Complete the prescribed scholarship application form.
2. Submit all required supporting documents.
3. Pay the prescribed registration fee, if applicable and officially announced.
4. Submit the application before the closing date.

Incomplete or late applications may not be considered.

6.4 Application Verification

Upon receipt of an application, AZM may:

- Review the application for completeness.
- Verify submitted documents.
- Request additional information.
- Reject incomplete or ineligible applications before further processing.

Only verified applicants shall proceed to the examination stage.

6.5 Written Examination

Eligible applicants shall appear in the written scholarship examination conducted by AZM.

The examination:

- Shall be conducted under standardized conditions.
- May consist of objective and/or subjective assessments.
- Shall follow the syllabus and format announced by AZM.
- Shall be supervised by authorized invigilators.

Any use of unfair means, impersonation, or misconduct during the examination shall result in immediate disqualification.

6.6 Interview

Applicants shortlisted by AZM may be invited for an interview.

The interview may assess:

- Communication skills.
- Academic motivation.
- Leadership potential.
- General awareness.
- Financial circumstances (where applicable).
- Overall suitability for the scholarship.

Attendance at the interview is mandatory where required.

6.7 Merit Evaluation

The Scholarship Committee shall prepare the merit list based on approved evaluation criteria, which may include:

- Written examination performance.
- Interview assessment.
- Academic record.
- Verification findings.
- Financial need (for applicable categories).
- Compliance with eligibility requirements.

The weightage assigned to each component shall be determined and announced by AZM.

6.8 Verification Before Award

Before final approval, AZM may conduct additional verification, including:

- Educational record verification.
- Identity verification.
- Financial verification.
- Institutional verification.
- Home visits (where necessary).

Failure to cooperate with verification may result in rejection or cancellation of the scholarship.

6.9 Preparation of the Merit List

The Scholarship Committee shall prepare the provisional merit list after completion of all evaluation stages.

The merit list shall be based on:

- Approved merit criteria.
- Verification outcomes.
- Scholarship category.
- Availability of scholarships.

The provisional merit list shall be submitted to the Director General & Chairperson for review and approval.

6.10 Approval of the Merit List

The final merit list shall become effective only after approval by the **Director General & Chairperson**.

AZM reserves the right to:

- Correct clerical or administrative errors.
- Remove ineligible candidates.
- Revise the merit list where justified by verified information.

6.11 Publication of Results

Final scholarship results shall be announced through official AZM communication channels.

The published merit list may include:

- Merit Position
- Scholarship ID
- Student Name
- Institution
- Scholarship Category
- Status (Selected/Waiting List, if applicable)

AZM may withhold personal information where necessary to protect privacy.

6.12 Acceptance of Scholarship

Selected applicants shall:

- Accept the scholarship within the prescribed time.
- Submit all required affidavits, undertakings, and agreements.
- Complete document verification.
- Comply with any additional reporting requirements specified by AZM.

Failure to complete these formalities may result in forfeiture of the scholarship offer.

6.13 Waiting List

Where applicable, AZM may maintain a waiting list.

If a selected student declines the scholarship, fails to report, or becomes ineligible, AZM may offer the scholarship to the next eligible candidate on the waiting list.

Inclusion on the waiting list does not guarantee the award of a scholarship.

6.14 Integrity of the Selection Process

No applicant, parent, educational institution, employee, volunteer, or third party shall attempt to influence the scholarship process through recommendations, gifts, payments, political influence, personal relationships, or any other improper means.

Any such attempt may result in disqualification and any additional action considered appropriate by AZM.

6.15 Final Authority

The **Director General & Chairperson**, acting on the recommendation of the Scholarship Committee, shall have the final administrative authority to approve or reject scholarship awards.

All decisions shall be made in accordance with this Policy Manual, applicable company policies, and the principles of fairness, transparency, and merit.

Chapter Summary

The scholarship application and selection process is designed to ensure equal opportunity, transparency, and merit-based decision-making. Every applicant shall be evaluated through a structured process involving application review, examination, interview (where applicable), verification, and final approval before the award of any scholarship.

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CHAPTER 7

SCHOLARSHIP TERMS, CONDITIONS & CODE OF CONDUCT

7.1 Purpose

This chapter sets out the mandatory terms, conditions, and standards of conduct applicable to all scholarship recipients. Acceptance of a scholarship constitutes acceptance of these conditions.

7.2 General Conditions

Every scholarship recipient shall:

1. Continue enrollment in the approved educational institution throughout the scholarship period.
2. Comply with all policies, rules, and procedures of AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd and the educational institution.
3. Maintain honesty, integrity, and professionalism in all academic and personal matters.
4. Cooperate with AZM in all scholarship-related activities, verifications, and evaluations.

7.3 Academic Performance

To remain eligible, every scholarship recipient shall:

- Maintain a minimum of **70% marks** in all internal examinations.
- Show satisfactory academic progress throughout the scholarship period.
- Submit academic results whenever requested by AZM.

Failure to meet the required academic standard may result in review, suspension, or cancellation of the scholarship.

7.4 Attendance Requirement

Every scholarship recipient shall maintain a minimum **90% attendance** unless a genuine reason is accepted by AZM.

Repeated unauthorized absences may result in disciplinary action.

7.5 Discipline & Conduct

Scholarship recipients shall:

- Maintain good moral character.
- Respect teachers, staff, fellow students, and AZM representatives.
- Follow institutional rules and regulations.
- Behave responsibly during all AZM activities and events.
- Protect the dignity, reputation, and values of AZM.

7.6 Prohibited Conduct

The following actions constitute violations of scholarship policy:

- Cheating or academic dishonesty.

- Submission of false information or forged documents.
- Bullying, harassment, discrimination, or violence.
- Criminal or unlawful activities.
- Damage to institutional or AZM property.
- Misuse of scholarship benefits.
- Bringing AZM or the educational institution into disrepute through conduct, including on social media.

Any such conduct may result in disciplinary action, including suspension or cancellation of the scholarship.

7.7 Participation in AZM Activities

Scholarship recipients may be required to attend:

- Orientation sessions.
- Scholarship meetings.
- Workshops and seminars.
- Award ceremonies.
- Interviews.
- Leadership or community service activities organized by AZM.

Reasonable failure to participate without prior approval may affect scholarship continuation.

7.8 Change in Circumstances

The parent/guardian or student shall promptly notify AZM of any significant change, including:

- Educational institution.
- Contact information.
- Residential address.
- Academic status.
- Financial circumstances.
- Guardian details.

Failure to report material changes may affect scholarship eligibility.

7.9 Monitoring & Verification

AZM reserves the right to monitor scholarship recipients through:

- Academic progress reviews.
- Attendance verification.
- School reports.
- Meetings with parents or school representatives.
- Home visits, where considered necessary.
- Verification of any information relevant to the scholarship.

Recipients and parents shall cooperate fully with these processes.

7.10 Use of Scholarship Benefits

Scholarship benefits shall:

- Be used solely for educational purposes.
- Not be transferred, sold, pledged, or exchanged.
- Be utilized responsibly in accordance with AZM policies.
- Candidates can avail Umrah Tickets within the time frame of **90** days. Expiry: 3-Months

7.11 Compliance with Future Policies

Scholarship recipients and their parents/guardians agree to comply with any future scholarship policies, operational guidelines, or administrative instructions issued by AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd during the scholarship period.

7.12 Suspension & Cancellation

AZM may suspend or cancel a scholarship where a recipient:

- Fails to maintain academic performance.
- Fails to maintain attendance.
- Violates this Policy Manual.
- Provides false or misleading information.
- Commits serious misconduct.
- Fails to cooperate with verification or monitoring procedures.

Any decision shall be made in accordance with the procedures set out in this Manual.

7.13 Final Administrative Authority

The **Director General & Chairperson**, upon the recommendation of the **Scholarship Committee**, shall have the authority to approve, suspend, renew, or cancel scholarships in accordance with this Policy Manual.

7.14 Reservation of Rights

AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd reserves the right to:

- Review compliance with scholarship conditions at any time.
- Amend scholarship terms and operational procedures.
- Require additional documentation or verification where reasonably necessary.
- Take appropriate administrative action in accordance with this Manual.

Chapter Summary

Scholarship recipients are expected to maintain academic excellence, discipline, integrity, and responsible conduct throughout the scholarship period. Continued receipt of scholarship benefits depends on compliance with these terms and the policies of AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd.

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CHAPTER 8

EXAMINATION, INTERVIEW & MERIT EVALUATION POLICY

8.1 Purpose

This chapter establishes the official policy governing the written examination, interview, evaluation, merit preparation, and final selection of scholarship recipients. It aims to ensure that all assessments are conducted fairly, objectively, transparently, and consistently.

8.2 Assessment Components

Selection under the AZM Scholarship Program shall be based on one or more of the following components:

- Written Examination
- Interview
- Document Verification
- Financial Assessment (where applicable)
- Academic Record
- Any additional evaluation approved by AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd.

8.3 Written Examination

The written examination shall be conducted according to the syllabus, format, and schedule announced by AZM.

The examination shall:

- Be conducted under the supervision of authorized invigilators.
- Be evaluated through the approved marking system.
- Be subject to quality assurance and moderation where required.

Any candidate using unfair means shall be immediately disqualified.

8.4 Interview Assessment

Only shortlisted candidates shall be invited for interviews.

The interview may assess:

- Communication Skills
- Academic Motivation
- Leadership Potential
- General Awareness
- Confidence & Personality
- Financial Need (where applicable)

The Scholarship Committee may ask any relevant questions necessary to evaluate the applicant.

8.5 Merit Calculation

Unless otherwise announced, the overall merit shall be calculated as follows:

- **Written Examination:** 60%
- **Interview:** 40%

The Scholarship Committee may revise the assessment methodology for future sessions with the approval of the Director General & Chairperson.

8.6 Merit Ranking

Applicants shall be ranked according to their final evaluated score.

Where two or more applicants obtain the same score, preference may be given based on:

- Higher Written Examination Marks.
- Better Interview Performance.
- Stronger Academic Record.
- Verified Financial Need (where applicable).
- Final recommendation of the Scholarship Committee.

8.7 Merit List Preparation

After completion of all assessment stages, the Scholarship Committee shall prepare a provisional merit list based on:

- Examination Results
- Interview Scores
- Verification Reports
- Eligibility Criteria
- Scholarship Categories
- Available Scholarship Seats

The provisional merit list shall be submitted to the Director General & Chairperson for approval.

8.8 Final Merit List

The merit list shall become official only after approval by the **Director General & Chairperson**.

The published merit list may include:

- Merit Position
- Scholarship ID
- Student Name
- Institution
- Scholarship Category

- Scholarship Status

AZM reserves the right to withhold or limit personal information in published results to protect privacy.

8.9 Integrity of the Assessment Process

The examination and interview process shall remain confidential and impartial.

No applicant, parent, educational institution, employee, volunteer, or third party shall attempt to influence the assessment through recommendations, gifts, payments, political influence, or any improper means.

Any such attempt may result in immediate disqualification.

8.10 Review of Results

To maintain the integrity and confidentiality of the evaluation process:

- Rechecking or re-evaluation of answer scripts or interview scores shall not ordinarily be permitted.
- Administrative or clerical errors identified by AZM may be corrected before or after publication of results.
- Verified errors affecting merit may result in revision of the merit list.

8.11 Confidentiality

Question papers, answer scripts, interview assessments, evaluation sheets, committee deliberations, and internal scoring records are confidential documents and shall not be disclosed except where required by law or authorized by AZM.

8.12 Final Authority

The **Director General & Chairperson**, upon the recommendation of the **Scholarship Committee**, shall have the final administrative authority regarding:

- Examination procedures.
- Interview evaluation.
- Merit calculation.
- Merit ranking.
- Scholarship allocation.
- Publication of results.

8.13 Reservation of Rights

AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd reserves the right to:

- Modify examination or interview procedures.
- Revise assessment criteria for future sessions.
- Cancel or reschedule examinations or interviews due to unforeseen circumstances.
- Conduct additional assessments where necessary.
- Correct administrative or clerical errors in the merit process.

Chapter Summary

The AZM Scholarship assessment process is based on transparency, merit, and fairness. Every applicant is evaluated through standardized procedures, and scholarship awards are made only after examination, interview, verification, and final approval in accordance with this Policy Manual.

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CHAPTER 9

SCHOLARSHIP AWARD, ACCEPTANCE & RENEWAL POLICY

9.1 Purpose

This chapter establishes the policies governing the award, acceptance, continuation, renewal, suspension, and completion of scholarships under the AZM Scholarship Program.

9.1.0 Financial Sustainability of Scholarship Awards

As the AZM Scholarship Program is entirely self-funded, continuation or renewal of any scholarship shall remain subject to:

- The student's continued eligibility.
- Compliance with this Policy Manual.
- The availability of approved scholarship funds.
- The annual budget approved by AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd.

Where financial or operational circumstances reasonably require, AZM may modify, defer, suspend, or discontinue scholarship benefits.

Such action shall not affect the validity of previous scholarship decisions already implemented, nor shall it create any obligation upon AZM to continue benefits beyond the approved scholarship period.

9.2 Award of Scholarship

A scholarship shall be awarded only after:

- Successful completion of the selection process.
- Verification of eligibility and supporting documents.
- Approval of the final merit list by the **Director General & Chairperson**.

An offer of scholarship shall remain provisional until all post-selection requirements have been completed.

9.3 Scholarship Acceptance

Every selected student and parent/guardian shall formally accept the scholarship by:

- Signing the Parent/Guardian Affidavit & Undertaking.
- Signing the Scholarship Acceptance Form.
- Signing the Scholarship Agreement (where applicable).
- Submitting all required documents within the prescribed timeline.

Failure to complete these requirements may result in withdrawal of the scholarship offer.

9.4 Reporting Requirements

Selected students shall report to AZM on the date, time, and venue notified by the organization.

At the time of reporting, students shall produce all original documents required for verification.

Failure to report without a valid reason may result in cancellation of the scholarship offer.

9.5 Commencement of Scholarship

The scholarship shall become effective only after:

- Completion of all acceptance formalities.
- Final verification of documents.
- Approval by the competent authority.
- Official issuance of the Scholarship Award Letter.

9.6 Duration of Scholarship

The duration of each scholarship shall depend on the category awarded.

Unless otherwise approved:

- **Full-Year Scholarship:** One Academic Year.
- **Semester Scholarship:** One Academic Semester.
- **Educational Benefits:** As approved by AZM.
- **Orphan & Financially Needy Scholarship:** For the approved period only.

Continuation beyond the approved duration shall not be automatic.

9.7 Renewal Policy

Renewal of a scholarship shall be considered only if the student:

- Maintains a minimum **70% marks** in internal examinations.
- Maintains **90% attendance**.
- Demonstrates satisfactory conduct and discipline.
- Continues enrollment at the approved institution.
- Complies with all provisions of this Policy Manual.
- Submits renewal documents within the prescribed time.

Renewal shall remain subject to the availability of scholarship funds and approval by AZM.

9.8 Monitoring of Scholarship Recipients

AZM may monitor scholarship recipients through:

- Academic progress reports.
- Attendance records.
- School feedback.
- Parent meetings.
- Student interviews.
- Verification visits, where necessary.

Students and parents shall cooperate fully with all monitoring activities.

9.9 Suspension of Scholarship

A scholarship may be suspended where a student:

- Fails to meet academic requirements.
- Falls below the required attendance.
- Violates scholarship conditions.
- Is under investigation for misconduct.
- Fails to cooperate with AZM.

During suspension, scholarship benefits may be withheld until the matter is resolved.

9.10 Cancellation of Scholarship

A scholarship may be cancelled if a student:

- Submits false or forged information.
- Commits serious misconduct.
- Withdraws from the approved institution without prior approval.
- Violates this Policy Manual.
- Is found ineligible after verification.

Cancellation shall be communicated in writing.

9.11 Completion of Scholarship

A scholarship shall conclude upon:

- Successful completion of the approved scholarship period.
- Fulfilment of all scholarship obligations.
- Submission of any required final reports or documents.

Upon completion, AZM may issue a Scholarship Completion Certificate or any other recognition it considers appropriate.

9.12 Reallocation of Scholarship

If a scholarship is declined, withdrawn, suspended, or cancelled before commencement, AZM may award it to the next eligible candidate on the approved waiting list.

No person shall have an automatic right to receive a reallocated scholarship.

9.13 Reservation of Rights

AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd reserves the right to:

- Review scholarship performance at any time.
- Require additional documentation.
- Modify renewal procedures.
- Amend scholarship conditions.
- Suspend, discontinue, or withdraw scholarships in accordance with this Policy Manual and applicable law.

9.14 Final Authority

The **Director General & Chairperson**, acting upon the recommendation of the **Scholarship Committee**, shall have the final administrative authority regarding:

- Award of scholarships.
- Acceptance of scholarship.
- Renewal decisions.
- Suspension.
- Cancellation.
- Completion of scholarship.
- Interpretation of this chapter.

Chapter Summary

The award of a scholarship marks the beginning of an ongoing commitment between AZM, the student, and the parent/guardian. Continued receipt of scholarship benefits depends on academic performance, discipline, compliance with scholarship policies, and successful completion of all renewal requirements.

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CHAPTER 10

MONITORING, COMPLIANCE, SUSPENSION & CANCELLATION POLICY

10.1 Purpose

This chapter establishes the procedures for monitoring scholarship recipients, ensuring compliance with scholarship conditions, and regulating the suspension or cancellation of scholarships where necessary. It aims to maintain the integrity, fairness, and credibility of the AZM Scholarship Program.

10.2 Monitoring & Evaluation

AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd shall continuously monitor scholarship recipients throughout the scholarship period to ensure compliance with all applicable policies.

Monitoring may include:

- Academic performance reviews.
- Attendance verification.
- Discipline and conduct reports.
- Meetings with students or parents.
- Feedback from partner institutions.
- Verification visits where deemed necessary.

10.3 Compliance Requirements

Every scholarship recipient shall:

- Maintain the required academic performance.
- Maintain minimum attendance requirements.
- Observe good discipline and ethical conduct.
- Submit progress reports and documents when requested.
- Cooperate fully with AZM's monitoring and verification activities.

Failure to comply may result in disciplinary action.

10.4 Warning Procedure

Where a student commits a minor violation of scholarship conditions, AZM may issue written warnings.

The warning process shall ordinarily consist of:

- **First Warning** – Written advisory and guidance.
- **Final Warning** – Formal notice requiring immediate corrective action.

Repeated or serious violations may lead directly to suspension or cancellation without prior warning.

10.5 Suspension of Scholarship

AZM may suspend a scholarship where:

- Academic performance falls below the required standard.
- Attendance requirements are not met.
- Required documents are not submitted.
- The student is under investigation for misconduct.

- The student or parent fails to cooperate with AZM.

During suspension, scholarship benefits may be temporarily withheld pending review.

10.6 Cancellation of Scholarship

A scholarship may be cancelled where a student or parent:

- Submits false, forged, or misleading information.
- Conceals material facts.
- Commits serious academic or disciplinary misconduct.
- Withdraws from the approved institution without prior approval.
- Violates the Scholarship Agreement or this Policy Manual.
- Misuses scholarship benefits.
- Refuses to cooperate with verification or monitoring procedures.

Cancellation shall take effect from the date specified in the official notification issued by AZM.

10.7 Investigation Procedure

Where a potential violation is identified, AZM may:

- Review relevant records and documents.
- Seek information from the educational institution.
- Meet with the student and/or parent.
- Conduct verification where necessary.
- Obtain recommendations from the Scholarship Committee.

Administrative action shall be based on the available evidence and the principles of fairness and impartiality.

10.8 Reinstatement

A suspended scholarship may be reinstated where:

- The identified deficiencies have been satisfactorily addressed.
- The student has resumed compliance with scholarship requirements.
- The Scholarship Committee recommends reinstatement.
- The Director General & Chairperson approves the reinstatement.

Reinstatement shall be at the sole discretion of AZM and shall not be automatic.

10.9 Record Keeping

AZM shall maintain official records relating to:

- Warnings.
- Suspensions.
- Investigations.
- Cancellations.

- Appeals.
- Compliance reports.

Such records shall be retained in accordance with AZM's records management policies.

10.10 Internal Review

A student or parent who believes that an administrative decision has been made in error may submit a written request for review within **15 calendar days** of receiving the decision.

The Scholarship Committee shall review the matter and submit its recommendation to the Director General & Chairperson.

10.11 Final Administrative Decision

Following completion of the internal review process, the decision of the **Director General & Chairperson** shall constitute the final administrative decision of AZM regarding the scholarship.

10.12 Reservation of Rights

AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd reserves the right to:

- Conduct monitoring and verification at any stage.
- Initiate disciplinary proceedings where appropriate.
- Suspend or cancel scholarships in accordance with this Manual.
- Amend monitoring procedures and compliance requirements as necessary.

10.13 General Principle

The objective of monitoring and compliance is not only to enforce scholarship conditions but also to support students in maintaining academic excellence, discipline, and responsible conduct throughout the scholarship period.

Chapter Summary

The effectiveness of the AZM Scholarship Program depends upon continuous monitoring, transparent compliance procedures, and consistent application of scholarship policies. Every scholarship recipient and parent/guardian shares responsibility for maintaining the standards expected by AZM.

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CHAPTER 11

SCHOLARSHIP COMMITTEE POLICY & STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURES (SOPs)

11.1 Purpose

This chapter establishes the composition, authority, responsibilities, operational procedures, and ethical standards of the **AZM Scholarship Committee**. The Committee shall function as the independent evaluation and recommendation body responsible for ensuring that scholarships are awarded fairly, transparently, and strictly in accordance with this Policy Manual.

11.2 Establishment

The **AZM Scholarship Committee** is hereby constituted as the official committee responsible for administering the scholarship selection process.

The Committee shall function under the supervision of the **Director General & Chairperson** and in accordance with the policies approved by the **Board of Directors**.

11.3 Composition

The Committee shall consist of members appointed by the Director General & Chairperson.

The Committee may include:

- Chairperson of the Committee
- Secretary
- Academic Evaluation Members
- Interview Panel Members
- Verification & Compliance Representative
- Finance Representative (where required)
- Legal/Policy Advisor (where required)
- Additional members as approved by the Director General.

The Director General may appoint, replace, or remove any member whenever necessary.

11.4 Tenure

Committee members shall serve for the period determined by the Director General & Chairperson and may be reappointed.

Membership may terminate upon:

- Resignation.
- Removal.
- Expiry of tenure.
- Misconduct.
- Conflict of interest.
- Failure to perform assigned duties.

11.5 Powers & Functions

The Committee shall:

- Review scholarship applications.
- Verify eligibility.
- Supervise examinations.
- Conduct interviews.
- Evaluate applicants.
- Prepare provisional merit lists.
- Recommend scholarship awards.
- Recommend suspension or cancellation where appropriate.
- Maintain official records.
- Submit reports to the Director General.

The Committee shall make recommendations only. Final approval shall rest with the Director General & Chairperson.

11.6 Meetings

The Committee shall meet whenever required.

Meetings may be held:

- Physically.
- Virtually.
- Through any approved communication platform.

The Chairperson may call emergency meetings where necessary.

11.7 Quorum

A meeting shall require at least **50% of the appointed members**, including the Committee Chairperson or an authorized nominee, to constitute a quorum.

If a quorum is not present, the meeting shall be adjourned and reconvened.

11.8 Decision-Making

The Committee shall strive to make decisions through consensus.

Where consensus cannot be achieved:

- Decisions shall be made by a simple majority of members present.
- In the event of a tie, the Committee Chairperson shall have a casting vote.
- Recommendations requiring final approval shall be forwarded to the Director General & Chairperson.

11.9 Confidentiality

Committee members shall maintain strict confidentiality regarding:

- Applications.
- Examination materials.

- Interview proceedings.
- Merit calculations.
- Deliberations.
- Verification reports.
- Scholarship decisions.

No member shall disclose confidential information except as authorized.

11.10 Conflict of Interest

Any member having a personal, financial, family, or professional relationship with an applicant shall immediately disclose the conflict.

Such member shall not:

- Evaluate the applicant.
- Participate in discussions relating to that applicant.
- Vote on matters affecting that applicant.

Failure to disclose a conflict of interest may result in removal from the Committee.

11.11 Code of Ethics

Committee members shall:

- Act honestly and impartially.
- Treat all applicants equally.
- Avoid favoritism.
- Maintain professional conduct.
- Protect confidential information.
- Base recommendations solely on approved evaluation criteria.

11.12 Record Keeping

The Committee shall maintain official records of:

- Meeting agendas.
- Attendance.
- Minutes of meetings.
- Examination reports.
- Interview evaluations.
- Verification reports.
- Merit lists.
- Recommendations.
- Official decisions.

All records shall remain the property of AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd.

11.13 Communication

No Committee member shall independently announce scholarship decisions or communicate official outcomes unless authorized by the Director General & Chairperson.

All official communications shall be issued only through authorized AZM channels.

11.14 Accountability

Committee members are accountable for:

- Fair evaluations.
- Accurate record keeping.
- Compliance with this Policy Manual.
- Professional conduct.
- Maintaining confidentiality.

Any breach may result in disciplinary action, including removal from the Committee.

11.15 Final Authority

The recommendations of the Scholarship Committee shall be submitted to the **Director General & Chairperson** for review and approval.

No recommendation shall become effective until formally approved by the Director General & Chairperson.

11.16 Reservation of Rights

AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd reserves the right to:

- Reconstitute the Committee.
- Amend its composition.
- Appoint additional members.
- Remove members for misconduct or conflict of interest.
- Revise Committee procedures through official policy amendments.

Chapter Summary

The AZM Scholarship Committee is entrusted with ensuring that every scholarship application is assessed objectively, consistently, and in accordance with approved policies. The Committee operates with integrity, impartiality, and accountability, while final administrative authority remains with the Director General & Chairperson.

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CHAPTER 12

FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT, SCHOLARSHIP FUND ADMINISTRATION & AUDIT POLICY

12.1 Purpose

This chapter establishes the financial governance framework for the AZM Scholarship Program. It aims to ensure that all scholarship funds, educational benefits, and financial resources are managed responsibly, transparently, and in accordance with the approved policies of **AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd**.

12.2 Financial Governance

The financial administration of the Scholarship Program shall be based on the principles of:

- Transparency
- Accountability
- Integrity
- Proper Financial Controls
- Responsible Resource Management
- Audit Compliance

12.3 Scholarship Fund

The AZM Scholarship Fund is financed exclusively through financial resources approved by **AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd**.

The Scholarship Program is **entirely self-funded** and operates independently of any obligation to receive government funding or external grants.

Where external donations, sponsorships, or grants are accepted, they shall supplement—but not alter—the governance or independence of the Scholarship Program, unless expressly approved by the Board of Directors.

The Board of Directors shall determine the annual scholarship budget based upon the financial position of the organization.

12.4 Annual Scholarship Budget

The Finance Department shall prepare an annual scholarship budget for approval by the **Board of Directors**.

The budget may include:

- Tuition Fee Scholarships
- Educational Benefits
- Examination Expenses
- Interview Expenses
- Verification Costs
- Administrative Expenses
- Awards & Recognition
- Technology & System Costs
- Contingency Provisions

No expenditure shall be made beyond the approved budget without proper authorization.

12.5 Financial Authorization

Financial approvals shall be exercised as follows:

Authority	Responsibility
Board of Directors	Approval of Annual Scholarship Budget
Director General & Chairperson	Approval of Scholarship Awards, Major Expenditures, and Exceptional Financial Decisions
Director Finance	Budget Implementation, Financial Control, and Record Management
Accounts Department	Processing of Approved Payments and Maintenance of Financial Records

No employee or committee member may authorize payments beyond their delegated authority.

12.6 Scholarship Disbursement

Scholarship payments or educational benefits shall be released only after:

- Approval of the final merit list.
- Completion of all verification procedures.
- Submission of required undertakings and documents.
- Authorization by the competent authority.

AZM may disburse scholarships directly to the educational institution or by any other approved method.

12.7 Educational Benefits

Educational benefits may include:

- Laptops
- Chromebooks
- Textbooks
- School Bags
- Stationery
- Examination Support
- Learning Materials
- Other educational assistance approved by AZM

Distribution shall be documented through official records and acknowledgements signed by recipients.

12.8 Financial Records

The Finance Department shall maintain complete records of:

- Scholarship Payments
- Educational Benefit Distribution
- Procurement Records
- Invoices
- Receipts

- Payment Vouchers
- Bank Records
- Financial Statements
- Audit Reports

All financial records shall be retained in accordance with AZM's document retention policy.

12.9 Procurement of Educational Materials

Procurement of laptops, books, stationery, and other educational items shall:

- Follow approved procurement procedures.
- Be based on quality, cost-effectiveness, and transparency.
- Be supported by quotations or competitive evaluation where appropriate.
- Be properly documented and approved.

12.10 Internal Financial Controls

AZM shall implement appropriate financial controls, including:

- Segregation of duties.
- Approval hierarchy.
- Budget monitoring.
- Payment authorization.
- Asset verification.
- Periodic financial reconciliation.

These controls are intended to safeguard scholarship resources and prevent misuse.

12.11 Audit

The Scholarship Program shall be subject to periodic internal audits and, where applicable, external audits.

Audits may examine:

- Financial transactions.
- Scholarship payments.
- Procurement activities.
- Educational benefit distribution.
- Compliance with approved policies.
- Accuracy of financial records.

All departments shall cooperate fully with audit activities.

12.12 Fraud Prevention

Any person involved in fraud, theft, embezzlement, bribery, financial misconduct, or misuse of scholarship funds or assets shall be subject to disciplinary action and any other measures permitted under applicable law.

12.13 Financial Reporting

The Director Finance shall prepare periodic financial reports for submission to the Director General & Chairperson and the Board of Directors.

Reports may include:

- Budget Utilization
- Scholarship Expenditure
- Outstanding Commitments
- Procurement Summary
- Educational Benefit Distribution
- Financial Performance

12.14 Transparency & Accountability

AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd is committed to ensuring that scholarship funds are administered responsibly and in accordance with approved policies.

Every employee, committee member, volunteer, and officer handling scholarship funds shall be accountable for safeguarding organizational resources.

12.15 Final Authority

The **Board of Directors** shall exercise overall financial oversight of the Scholarship Program.

The **Director General & Chairperson** shall have the authority to approve scholarship expenditures, exceptional financial decisions, and operational allocations within the framework of Board-approved policies and budgets.

12.16 Reservation of Rights

AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd reserves the right to:

- Amend financial procedures.
- Reallocate scholarship budgets.
- Modify scholarship funding priorities.
- Introduce additional financial controls.
- Suspend expenditures where necessary to protect the interests of the organization.

12.17 Financial Sustainability

The long-term sustainability of the Scholarship Program shall be a primary consideration in all financial decisions.

Accordingly, AZM reserves the right to:

- Adjust the number of scholarships awarded.
- Modify scholarship categories.
- Revise educational benefits.

- Defer or reschedule scholarship disbursements where reasonably necessary.
- Introduce new scholarship models.
- Suspend or discontinue any component of the Scholarship Program if continuation would adversely affect the financial sustainability of the organization.

These decisions shall be made in good faith, taking into account the interests of both the organization and scholarship recipients.

Chapter Summary

Sound financial management is essential to the credibility and sustainability of the AZM Scholarship Program. All scholarship funds and educational resources shall be administered with transparency, accountability, and appropriate oversight to ensure they are used solely for their intended educational purpose.

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CHAPTER 13

FRAUD PREVENTION, ANTI-CORRUPTION & ETHICS POLICY

13.1 Purpose

This chapter establishes the ethical standards, anti-fraud measures, anti-corruption principles, and reporting procedures applicable to all persons involved in the AZM Scholarship Program. It aims to protect the integrity, credibility, and reputation of AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd by ensuring that all scholarship-related activities are conducted honestly, fairly, and transparently.

13.2 Scope

This policy applies to:

- Board of Directors
- Director General & Chairperson
- Executive Management
- Scholarship Committee Members
- Employees
- Volunteers
- Consultants
- Partner Institutions
- Scholarship Applicants
- Parents/Guardians
- Scholarship Recipients
- Any individual acting on behalf of AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd

13.3 Guiding Principles

All scholarship activities shall be conducted with:

- Integrity
- Honesty
- Fairness
- Transparency
- Accountability
- Impartiality
- Professionalism
- Respect for the law

13.4 Prohibited Conduct

The following actions are strictly prohibited:

- Bribery or offering any financial or personal benefit to influence scholarship decisions.
- Accepting gifts, favors, or incentives in exchange for preferential treatment.
- Manipulation of examination, interview, or merit records.
- Forgery, alteration, or destruction of official documents.
- Misuse or unauthorized disclosure of confidential information.
- Nepotism, favoritism, or discrimination in the selection process.
- Misappropriation or misuse of scholarship funds or educational resources.
- Abuse of official authority or position.
- Providing false information or misleading statements.
- Any conduct intended to compromise the fairness or integrity of the Scholarship Program.

13.5 Gifts & Hospitality

No employee, committee member, volunteer, or representative of AZM shall solicit or accept gifts, hospitality, money, services, or other benefits that may influence, or appear to influence, the scholarship process.

Nominal ceremonial gifts may only be accepted where permitted by organizational policy and approved by the Director General & Chairperson.

13.6 Conflict of Interest

Every person involved in scholarship administration shall disclose any actual, potential, or perceived conflict of interest.

Individuals with a conflict of interest shall not participate in the evaluation, recommendation, or approval of the affected applicant.

13.7 Fraud Prevention Measures

To reduce the risk of fraud, AZM may implement:

- Identity verification.

- Document authentication.
- Academic record verification.
- Financial verification.
- Random audits.
- Home verification visits.
- Digital record management.
- Dual authorization for critical decisions.
- Periodic review of scholarship records.

13.8 Reporting Misconduct (Whistleblower Protection)

Any individual who becomes aware of fraud, corruption, unethical conduct, or serious policy violations is encouraged to report the matter through the official channels designated by AZM.

Reports shall be treated confidentially to the extent reasonably possible, and no person shall be subjected to retaliation for making a report in good faith.

Knowingly false or malicious complaints may result in appropriate disciplinary action.

13.9 Investigation Procedure

Where an allegation of fraud or misconduct is received, AZM may:

- Conduct a preliminary review.
- Collect relevant documents and evidence.
- Interview concerned individuals.
- Obtain reports from partner institutions or other relevant parties.
- Refer the matter to the Scholarship Committee or another authorized body for review.

Investigations shall be conducted impartially and in accordance with the principles of procedural fairness.

13.10 Disciplinary Measures

Where misconduct is established, AZM may take one or more of the following actions, as appropriate:

- Written warning.
- Removal from the Scholarship Committee or volunteer position.
- Suspension of scholarship benefits.
- Cancellation of scholarship.
- Recovery of improperly obtained benefits where permitted by law.
- Referral to relevant authorities where legally required or appropriate.

The nature of the action shall be proportionate to the seriousness of the misconduct.

13.11 Confidentiality

Information relating to allegations, investigations, reports, and decisions shall be treated as confidential and disclosed only to persons with a legitimate need to know or where required by law.

13.12 Responsibilities

All stakeholders shall:

- Act honestly and ethically.
- Report suspected misconduct in good faith.
- Cooperate with investigations.
- Protect the reputation and integrity of AZM.
- Comply with this Policy Manual.

13.13 Final Authority

The **Director General & Chairperson**, acting upon recommendations from the appropriate committee or authorized officials, shall make the final administrative decision regarding disciplinary action under this chapter.

13.14 Reservation of Rights

AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd reserves the right to:

- Review allegations of misconduct.
- Amend anti-fraud procedures.
- Strengthen internal controls.
- Introduce additional compliance measures.
- Take any administrative action consistent with this Policy Manual and applicable law.

Chapter Summary

The AZM Scholarship Program is founded on integrity, fairness, and accountability. Every person involved in the program has a responsibility to uphold these standards and to contribute to a transparent and ethical scholarship process. Fraud, corruption, and misconduct undermine public trust and will not be tolerated.

Document Control

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Chapter: 13 – Fraud Prevention, Anti-Corruption & Ethics Policy

Version: 1.0

CHAPTER 14

DATA PROTECTION, PRIVACY & CONFIDENTIALITY POLICY

14.1 Purpose

This chapter establishes the principles and procedures for the collection, use, storage, protection, retention, and disclosure of personal information obtained during the administration of the AZM Scholarship Program. It aims to safeguard the privacy of applicants and ensure that scholarship records are handled responsibly, securely, and only for legitimate organizational purposes.

14.2 Scope

This policy applies to:

- Board of Directors
- Director General & Chairperson
- Executive Management
- Scholarship Committee
- Employees
- Volunteers
- Consultants
- Partner Educational Institutions
- Applicants
- Parents/Guardians
- Scholarship Recipients

14.3 Information Collected

AZM may collect information including, but not limited to:

- Student Name
- Parent/Guardian Details
- CNIC/B-Form Information
- Contact Information
- Residential Address
- Academic Records
- Financial Information
- Attendance Records
- Examination & Interview Results
- Photographs
- Supporting Documents
- Scholarship Records

Only information necessary for scholarship administration shall be collected.

14.4 Purpose of Collection

Personal information may be collected for the following purposes:

- Processing scholarship applications.
- Identity verification.
- Merit evaluation.
- Financial assessment.
- Scholarship administration.
- Communication with applicants.
- Monitoring scholarship performance.
- Reporting and audit requirements.
- Compliance with applicable legal or regulatory obligations.

14.5 Confidentiality

All personal information and scholarship records shall be treated as confidential.

No employee, committee member, volunteer, or representative shall disclose confidential information except:

- For official organizational purposes.
- With the consent of the applicant or parent, where appropriate.
- Where disclosure is required by applicable law or a lawful order.

Unauthorized disclosure of confidential information may result in disciplinary action.

14.6 Access to Information

Access to scholarship records shall be limited to authorized personnel whose official duties require such access.

Each authorized person shall access only the information necessary to perform their assigned responsibilities.

14.7 Storage & Security

AZM shall implement reasonable administrative, physical, and technical measures to protect scholarship records from:

- Unauthorized access.
- Loss or theft.
- Alteration or destruction.
- Misuse.
- Unauthorized disclosure.

Both physical and electronic records shall be maintained securely.

14.8 Retention of Records

Scholarship records shall be retained for the period determined by AZM's Records Management Policy or as required by applicable law.

After the retention period, records may be securely archived or disposed of in accordance with approved procedures.

14.9 Use of Photographs & Media

AZM may capture photographs, videos, or recordings during scholarship examinations, interviews, award ceremonies, training sessions, workshops, or official events.

Such materials may be used for:

- Official reports.
- Organizational publications.

- Website and social media.
- Promotional and educational materials.
- Annual reports.

Where required, consent shall be obtained through the Scholarship Application Form, Parent/Guardian Affidavit, or a separate Media Consent Form.

14.10 Information Sharing

AZM may share relevant information only with:

- Partner Educational Institutions.
- Authorized Verification Agencies.
- Auditors.
- Legal or Regulatory Authorities.
- Service Providers engaged by AZM for scholarship administration.

Information shall be shared only to the extent reasonably necessary for legitimate purposes.

14.11 Applicant Responsibilities

Applicants and parents shall:

- Provide accurate information.
- Promptly notify AZM of material changes.
- Cooperate with verification requests.
- Safeguard any login credentials or scholarship identification issued by AZM.

14.12 Breach of Confidentiality

Any unauthorized access, disclosure, alteration, or misuse of confidential information shall be investigated.

Where a breach is established, AZM may take disciplinary or administrative action appropriate to the circumstances.

14.13 Final Authority

The **Director General & Chairperson** shall oversee the implementation of this policy and may issue additional procedures for the protection of scholarship information.

14.14 Reservation of Rights

AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd reserves the right to:

- Introduce enhanced security measures.
- Modify data management procedures.
- Digitize scholarship records.
- Establish secure electronic scholarship management systems.
- Amend this policy to meet operational or legal requirements.

Chapter Summary

Protecting the privacy and confidentiality of scholarship applicants is essential to maintaining public trust. All scholarship information shall be collected, used, stored, and disclosed responsibly, securely, and only for legitimate purposes related to the administration of the AZM Scholarship Program.

Document Control

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Chapter: 14 – Data Protection, Privacy & Confidentiality Policy

Version: 1.0

Approved By: Board of Directors, AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd

CHAPTER 15

APPEALS, COMPLAINTS & GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL POLICY

15.1 Purpose

This chapter establishes the official procedure for submitting, reviewing, and resolving complaints, appeals, and grievances relating to the AZM Scholarship Program. It aims to ensure that concerns are handled fairly, professionally, confidentially, and within a reasonable timeframe while maintaining the integrity of the scholarship process.

15.2 Guiding Principles

The grievance process shall be based upon:

- Fairness
- Transparency
- Confidentiality
- Impartiality
- Respect
- Timely Resolution
- Good Faith

15.3 Right to Submit a Grievance

Any applicant, parent/guardian, scholarship recipient, or partner institution may submit a written grievance relating to:

- Administrative errors.
- Scholarship procedures.
- Document verification.
- Conduct of scholarship officials.
- Interpretation of scholarship policies.
- Any other scholarship-related administrative matter.

Complaints must be submitted respectfully and supported by relevant facts or evidence where available.

15.4 Matters That Will Not Be Entertained

AZM shall not entertain complaints relating to:

- Demands for a scholarship despite not meeting eligibility requirements.
- Requests to increase an awarded scholarship category.
- Requests for additional financial assistance beyond approved benefits.
- Re-evaluation of examination papers or interview scores, except to correct verified clerical or administrative errors.
- Complaints based solely on dissatisfaction with merit ranking without evidence of an administrative error.

15.5 Submission Procedure

A grievance shall:

- Be submitted in writing.
- Include the applicant's name, Scholarship ID (if available), contact details, and supporting information.
- Be submitted within **15 calendar days** from the date of the relevant decision.

Late or anonymous complaints may be declined unless exceptional circumstances exist.

15.6 Review Process

Upon receiving a complaint, AZM may:

- Acknowledge receipt.
- Review the submitted information.
- Seek clarification from the applicant or parent.
- Examine relevant records.
- Obtain reports from the Scholarship Committee or partner institution.
- Conduct further verification where appropriate.

15.7 Decision

Following review, AZM may:

- Dismiss the complaint.
- Correct an administrative or clerical error.
- Confirm the original decision.
- Take any other administrative action considered appropriate under this Policy Manual.

The decision shall be communicated in writing or through an official communication channel.

15.8 Frivolous or Malicious Complaints

Any person who knowingly submits false, fabricated, malicious, or misleading allegations against AZM, its officials, employees, volunteers, or partner institutions may be subject to appropriate administrative action, including disqualification from the scholarship program where justified.

15.9 Self-Funded Nature of the Scholarship Program

The AZM Scholarship Program is **entirely self-funded** by **AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd** and its approved financial resources.

Scholarship awards, categories, educational benefits, and the number of scholarships offered each year are subject to the organization's financial capacity, operational priorities, and approved budget.

Accordingly:

- Scholarships are **voluntary educational assistance** and not a legal entitlement.
- AZM does not guarantee that the same number, value, or category of scholarships will be available in future sessions.
- AZM may increase, reduce, postpone, modify, or discontinue any scholarship category or benefit if financial or operational circumstances require such action.
- No applicant or scholarship recipient shall have any right to claim compensation, damages, or continuation of scholarship benefits solely because funding levels, scholarship categories, or program structure have changed.

15.10 Limitation of Financial Obligation

As a self-funded initiative, AZM shall not incur financial obligations beyond the scholarship benefits formally approved for a recipient.

No representation, announcement, discussion, promotional material, or expectation shall create any obligation upon AZM beyond the terms contained in the official Scholarship Award Letter and this Policy Manual.

15.11 Final Administrative Decision

After completion of the internal review process, the decision of the **Director General & Chairperson**, acting upon the recommendation of the Scholarship Committee where appropriate, shall constitute the **final administrative decision** of AZM regarding the matter.

15.12 Reservation of Right

AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd reserves the right to:

- Modify grievance procedures.
- Establish additional review mechanisms.
- Correct administrative errors.
- Decline complaints that fall outside the scope of this policy.
- Amend this chapter in accordance with organizational requirements and applicable law.

Chapter Summary

AZM is committed to addressing genuine concerns through a structured and transparent internal review process. At the same time, the Scholarship Program remains a **self-funded charitable educational initiative**, and all scholarship awards are subject to the organization's financial resources, approved policies, and administrative decisions.

Document Control

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Chapter: 15 – Appeals, Complaints & Grievance Redressal Policy

Version: 1.0

Approved By: Board of Directors, AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd

Chapter 16 – Finality of Scholarship Decisions

Policy Statement

The AZM Scholarship Program is a voluntary educational initiative administered by **AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd**. Scholarships are awarded solely on the basis of approved eligibility criteria, merit, verification, interview assessment, available resources, and company policies.

The **Director General & Chairperson**, acting on the recommendations of the **AZM Scholarship Committee**, shall have final authority regarding:

- Scholarship eligibility.
- Merit determination.
- Scholarship category and benefits.
- Document verification.
- Continuation, suspension, or cancellation of scholarships.
- Interpretation of scholarship policies.
- Administrative decisions relating to the Scholarship Program.

The Scholarship Committee shall evaluate applications objectively and maintain written records of its decisions.

Chapter 17 – Reservation of Rights

AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd reserves the right to:

- Amend, revise, suspend, or replace any scholarship policy.
- Modify scholarship benefits or categories.
- Change eligibility criteria.
- Increase or decrease the number of scholarships.
- Conduct additional verification whenever necessary.
- Suspend or discontinue the Scholarship Program if required due to financial, administrative, legal, or operational reasons.

No scholarship recipient shall acquire any ownership, employment, partnership, or contractual rights against AZM merely by receiving scholarship assistance.

Chapter 18 – Internal Grievance & Review Procedure

Any applicant or parent who wishes to raise a concern regarding the scholarship process shall submit a written application to the Scholarship Committee within **15 calendar days** of the relevant decision.

The Committee shall review the matter and submit its findings to the Director General & Chairperson.

The decision communicated after completion of the internal review process shall be the final administrative decision of AZM.

Complaints made through social media, third parties, or unofficial channels shall not be treated as formal grievances.

Chapter 19 – Good Faith & Verification Policy

All scholarship decisions are made in good faith based on the information available at the time of assessment.

AZM reserves the right to reopen any scholarship case where:

- False information is discovered.
- Forged documents are identified.
- Material facts were concealed.
- Eligibility requirements were not actually fulfilled.

Where appropriate, scholarship benefits may be suspended or withdrawn following review.

Chapter 20 – Fraud, Misrepresentation & Non-Disclosure

Submission of false, forged, misleading, altered, or concealed information shall constitute a serious violation of scholarship policy.

AZM may:

- Cancel the scholarship.
- Remove the student from future scholarship programs.
- Notify the relevant educational institution where appropriate.
- Take any other action permitted under applicable law and company policy.

Chapter 21 – Limitation of Liability

AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd administers scholarships solely as an educational welfare initiative.

Except where prohibited by applicable law, AZM shall not be responsible for indirect, incidental, or consequential losses arising from:

- Scholarship decisions.
- Delays in processing.
- Modification of scholarship benefits.
- Suspension or discontinuation of the Scholarship Program.

This clause does not limit any legal obligations that cannot lawfully be excluded.

Chapter 22 – Parent & Student Acknowledgement

Before receiving any scholarship benefit, the parent/guardian and student shall:

- Sign the required affidavits and undertakings.
- Accept the Scholarship Policy Manual.
- Comply with all current and future scholarship regulations.
- Cooperate in verification and monitoring procedures.

Failure to complete these requirements may result in withholding or cancellation of scholarship benefits.

Chapter 23 – Interpretation of the Policy

If any provision of this Policy Manual requires interpretation or clarification, the matter shall be determined by the Director General & Chairperson in consultation with the Scholarship Committee.

Any amendment or clarification approved by AZM shall form part of this Policy Manual from its effective date.

Chapter 24 – Severability

If any provision of this Policy Manual is held to be invalid or unenforceable under applicable law, the remaining provisions shall continue in full force and effect to the maximum extent permitted by law.

Chapter 25 – General Provisions

1. Participation in the AZM Scholarship Program constitutes acceptance of this Policy Manual.
2. Scholarships are discretionary educational assistance and are not guaranteed or automatically renewable.
3. Scholarship continuation depends upon compliance with all applicable policies.
4. All official communications shall be made through the channels designated by AZM.
5. Matters not expressly covered in this Manual shall be decided by the Director General & Chairperson in consultation with the Scholarship Committee.
6. This Policy Manual shall be reviewed periodically and may be revised with the approval of the Board of Directors.
7. **All rights relating to the AZM Scholarship Program are reserved by AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd, subject to applicable law.**

ARTICLES: AWARD COLLECTION, EXPIRY & UNCLAIMED AWARDS POLICY

Article 25 – Application of Policy

Any scholarship, Umrah ticket, laptop, cash award, certificate, educational package, or other benefit awarded or announced by **AZM.AIO Pvt. Ltd.** shall be governed strictly by the terms, conditions, deadlines, and procedures prescribed by the Company.

Acceptance, selection, or announcement of an award shall not create an unconditional or perpetual entitlement to that award.

Article 26 – Mandatory Compliance

Every recipient shall be personally responsible for:

- Collecting the award within the prescribed period;
- Completing all required documentation;
- Providing accurate and valid information;
- Completing verification and formalities;
- Remaining available through the registered contact details;
- Monitoring official AZM communications; and
- Complying with all deadlines communicated by AZM.

Failure to comply with any applicable requirement may result in forfeiture or expiry of the award.

Article 27 – Attendance at Award Ceremony

Attendance at an official AZM Scholarship Awarding Ceremony does **not** automatically preserve, extend, or guarantee an award.

A recipient who is physically present but fails to collect, acknowledge, process, or complete the formalities relating to an award shall remain subject to the applicable collection deadline.

Article 28 – Umrah Award: Strict Three-Month Validity

Every **Umrah ticket, Umrah award, or Umrah sponsorship** issued by AZM shall have a maximum validity period of **three (3) months from the date of official issuance/award**, unless a different period is expressly stated in the written award document.

The recipient must complete **all required verification, documentation, booking, passport, travel, and other applicable formalities within this three-month period**.

The expiry date shall be treated as a firm deadline.

No automatic extension shall be granted merely because the recipient failed to act within the prescribed period.

Article 29 – Effect of Expiry

Upon expiry of the three-month Umrah validity period:

1. The award shall automatically be treated as **expired and closed**.
2. The recipient shall have no automatic right to demand an extension.
3. AZM shall not ordinarily be required to issue a replacement ticket.
4. The recipient shall not be entitled to demand a cash equivalent.
5. The recipient shall not be entitled to demand an alternative prize.
6. The original award may be cancelled, withdrawn, reallocated, or otherwise dealt with by AZM in accordance with Company policy.

Expiry shall occur regardless of whether the recipient attended the original ceremony.

Article 30 – Failure to Collect or Process the Award

An award may be treated as unclaimed or forfeited where the recipient:

- Fails to collect it;
- Refuses or declines to receive it;
- Leaves the ceremony without completing collection formalities;

- Fails to submit required documents;
- Fails to complete verification;
- Fails to contact the designated AZM office;
- Remains unreachable;
- Delays the process without an approved reason;
- Fails to complete travel formalities within the validity period; or
- Otherwise fails to comply with the prescribed requirements.

Article 31 – “I Forgot” or Lack of Awareness

The following shall **not ordinarily constitute valid grounds** for extending or reinstating an expired award:

- Forgetting the ceremony date;
- Forgetting the award deadline;
- Forgetting to collect an award;
- Forgetting to contact AZM;
- Failure to check messages;
- Failure to check WhatsApp;
- Failure to check the website or official announcements;
- Assuming that AZM would contact the recipient repeatedly; or
- Any similar failure of personal diligence.

Recipients are expected to remain informed and comply with published requirements.

Article 32 – “AZM Did Not Inform Me” Claims

AZM may communicate important information through its official communication channels, including official WhatsApp groups/broadcasts, SMS, telephone, website, partner institutions, social media, written notices, or other approved methods.

Where AZM has reasonably published or communicated the relevant information through an official channel, a recipient shall remain responsible for checking and complying with it.

Failure to personally receive, read, notice, save, or remember a communication shall **not automatically invalidate an officially published deadline or requirement**.

Article 33 – Incorrect or Inactive Contact Information

AZM shall not ordinarily be responsible for communication failures resulting from:

- Incorrect contact information supplied by the recipient;
- A changed telephone number;
- An inactive SIM;
- Blocked WhatsApp account;
- Full inbox;
- Lost or damaged mobile device;
- Network problems;
- Failure to update contact details; or
- Failure to remain connected with official AZM communication channels.

Recipients must immediately notify AZM of any change in contact information.

Article 34 – Ordinary Excuses

The following shall not automatically qualify for an extension:

- Personal engagements;
- Family functions;
- Travel plans;
- Lack of personal planning;
- Forgetfulness;
- Academic or work commitments;
- Transportation inconvenience;
- Failure to arrange documents on time;
- Financial inconvenience caused by the recipient;
- Failure to obtain information independently; or
- Any other ordinary personal circumstance.

An exception may only be considered where the competent authority determines that the circumstances genuinely justify special consideration.

Article 35 – Genuine Emergency

AZM may consider an extension only in an **exceptional and genuinely unavoidable circumstance**, such as:

- Serious medical emergency;
- Death of an immediate family member;
- Major accident;
- Natural disaster;
- Government-imposed travel restriction; or
- Another extraordinary circumstance beyond the recipient's reasonable control.

Documentary evidence may be required.

The burden of establishing the exceptional circumstance shall rest with the recipient.

Article 36 – Extension Request

Any request for extension should, wherever reasonably possible, be submitted **before the expiry of the award** and accompanied by supporting evidence.

Submission of a request does not itself extend the validity of the award.

An extension shall become effective only when expressly approved in writing by the competent authority.

Article 37 – No Automatic Cash Conversion

An Umrah award, laptop, educational package, or other non-cash award shall not be converted into cash merely because:

- The recipient does not wish to use it;
- The recipient cannot arrange the required formalities;
- The recipient fails to use it within the validity period; or
- The recipient subsequently requests an alternative.

Any alternative arrangement shall require express approval by AZM.

Article 38 – Declined Awards

Where a recipient expressly declines an award, AZM may treat the award as voluntarily surrendered.

A recipient who voluntarily declines an award shall not subsequently acquire an automatic right to reclaim the same award.

Article 39 – Repeated or Duplicate Claims

A recipient shall not be entitled to claim the same award more than once.

A previously awarded, collected, declined, forfeited, expired, cancelled, or reallocated award shall not be reopened merely because the recipient later submits a new claim.

False or duplicate claims may result in disqualification from future AZM programs.

Article 40 – Reallocation of Expired or Forfeited Awards

Any award that is expired, unclaimed, declined, cancelled, or forfeited may, at AZM's discretion:

- Be reallocated to another eligible candidate;
- Be transferred to a future scholarship session;
- Be utilized for another welfare initiative; or
- Be dealt with through any other lawful mechanism approved by the Company.

Once an award has been formally reallocated or otherwise closed, the original recipient shall have **no automatic entitlement to reclaim it**.

Article 41 – False Statements and Fraudulent Claims

Any recipient who knowingly submits false information, fabricated evidence, fraudulent documents, or a false explanation to obtain an extension or recover an expired award may:

- Have the award permanently cancelled;
- Be disqualified from future AZM programs;
- Be referred for disciplinary or legal action where appropriate; and
- Lose eligibility for other benefits under AZM programs.

Article 42 – No Verbal Commitment

No employee, volunteer, committee member, partner institution, representative, or other unauthorized person may extend, reinstate, replace, or guarantee an expired award through a verbal promise or unofficial communication.

Only an authorized written decision of AZM shall alter the applicable award conditions.

Article 43 – Finality of Administrative Decision

All matters relating to award collection, expiry, forfeiture, extension, cancellation, and reallocation shall be dealt with strictly in accordance with AZM's approved policies.

The recommendation of the relevant committee, where applicable, shall be submitted to the competent authority.

The decision of the **Director General & Chairperson**, made in accordance with Company policy and applicable law, shall be **final and binding for AZM's internal scholarship administration**.

Article 44 – No Waiver by Previous Practice

Failure by AZM to enforce a particular deadline or condition in one case shall not constitute a waiver of that condition in any other case.

Any special consideration granted in an individual case shall not create a precedent or establish a right for other recipients.

Article 45 – Acknowledgement by Recipient

By accepting participation in an AZM scholarship or award program, the recipient and, where applicable, the parent or guardian acknowledge that:

- Awards are conditional;
- Deadlines are mandatory;
- The recipient is responsible for completing required formalities;
- Unclaimed awards may expire;
- An Umrah award has a strict **three-month validity period** unless expressly varied in writing;
- Exceptions are discretionary and require approval; and
- Failure to comply may result in permanent forfeiture of the award.

Article 46 – Governing Provision

This Policy shall be read together with the **AZM Company Act, Scholarship Policy, official award notification, and other applicable Company policies**.

Where a matter is not specifically addressed, it shall be determined by the competent authority in accordance with the Company's objectives, approved policies, and applicable law.

CHAPTER 26

LEGAL FRAMEWORK, INTERPRETATION, AMENDMENTS & GENERAL PROVISIONS

26.1 Purpose

This chapter establishes the legal and administrative framework governing the AZM Scholarship Program. It defines the interpretation of this Policy Manual, amendment procedures, legal compliance, and general provisions applicable to all stakeholders.

26.2 Nature of the Scholarship Program

The AZM Scholarship Program is a **voluntary, charitable, educational welfare initiative** established and administered by **AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd**.

The Program is **entirely self-funded** and operates solely in accordance with the approved policies, financial capacity, and governance framework of AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd.

Participation in the Program shall not create any employment, partnership, agency, ownership, or commercial relationship between AZM and any applicant, parent, guardian, or scholarship recipient.

26.3 Interpretation of this Policy Manual

This Policy Manual shall be interpreted:

- As a whole document.
- In good faith.
- Consistent with its educational objectives.
- In accordance with the governance principles of AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd.
- Subject to the applicable laws of the Islamic Republic of Pakistan.

Where uncertainty exists regarding the interpretation of any provision, the matter shall be referred to the **Director General & Chairperson**, whose interpretation shall apply for administrative purposes unless modified by the Board of Directors or required otherwise by applicable law.

26.4 Compliance with Applicable Law

All scholarship activities shall be conducted in accordance with:

- Applicable laws of Pakistan.
- Applicable educational regulations.
- Company policies.
- Board-approved governance documents.

If any provision of this Manual conflicts with mandatory legal requirements, the applicable law shall prevail to the extent of that conflict, while the remaining provisions shall continue in force.

26.5 Amendments

The Board of Directors may amend, revise, replace, or repeal any provision of this Policy Manual whenever necessary.

Amendments may be made to:

- Scholarship categories.
- Eligibility criteria.
- Financial policies.
- Administrative procedures.
- Operational guidelines.
- Governance framework.
- Any other provision considered necessary.

Approved amendments shall become effective from the date specified in the relevant Board Resolution.

26.6 Official Communications

Official scholarship communications shall be issued only through channels authorized by AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd.

Applicants and scholarship recipients shall rely only on official notices, letters, emails, the official website, verified social media accounts, or other communication methods approved by AZM.

AZM shall not be responsible for misinformation circulated through unofficial sources.

26.7 Force Majeure

AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd shall not be responsible for delays, postponements, or interruptions caused by circumstances beyond its reasonable control, including but not limited to:

- Natural disasters.
- Public health emergencies.
- Government restrictions.
- Civil unrest.
- Technical failures.
- Security concerns.
- Any other unforeseen event materially affecting the operation of the Scholarship Program.

In such circumstances, AZM may reschedule, modify, suspend, or cancel any scholarship activity where reasonably necessary.

26.8 Severability

If any provision of this Policy Manual is declared invalid, illegal, or unenforceable by a competent authority, the remaining provisions shall continue in full force and effect to the maximum extent permitted by applicable law.

26.9 Waiver

Failure by AZM to enforce any provision of this Policy Manual on one occasion shall not constitute a waiver of its right to enforce that provision or any other provision in the future.

Any waiver must be made in writing by an authorized representative of AZM.

26.10 Intellectual Property

All scholarship documents, examination papers, interview materials, manuals, forms, policies, branding, logos, publications, and digital content developed by or for AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd remain the exclusive intellectual property of the organization unless otherwise stated.

No person may reproduce, modify, distribute, publish, or use such materials without prior written authorization from AZM.

26.11 Reservation of Rights

AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd expressly reserves all rights relating to:

- Administration of the Scholarship Program.
- Scholarship categories and benefits.

- Eligibility criteria.
- Merit evaluation.
- Financial allocations.
- Operational procedures.
- Policy interpretation.
- Future amendments.
- Educational initiatives associated with the Scholarship Program.

Any matter not specifically addressed in this Manual shall be decided by the Director General & Chairperson, subject to Board oversight and applicable law.

26.12 Effective Date

This Policy Manual shall come into effect on the date approved by the **Board of Directors of AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd** and shall remain in force until amended or replaced.

26.13 Approval

This Manual is issued under the authority of the **Board of Directors of AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd** and shall serve as the official governing document for the administration of the AZM Scholarship Program.

26.14 Certification

Document Title: AZM Scholarship Policy Manual

Document Code: AZM-POL-001

Version: 1.0

Approved By: Board of Directors

Issued By: Director General & Chairperson

Effective Date: _____

Next Review Date: _____

Classification: Official Internal Policy Document

FINAL DECLARATION

The Board of Directors of AZM.AIO Pvt Ltd hereby adopts this Scholarship Policy Manual as the official policy governing the AZM Scholarship Program. All officers, employees, committee members, volunteers, partner institutions, applicants, parents/guardians, and scholarship recipients shall comply with the provisions of this Manual in the administration and participation of the Program.